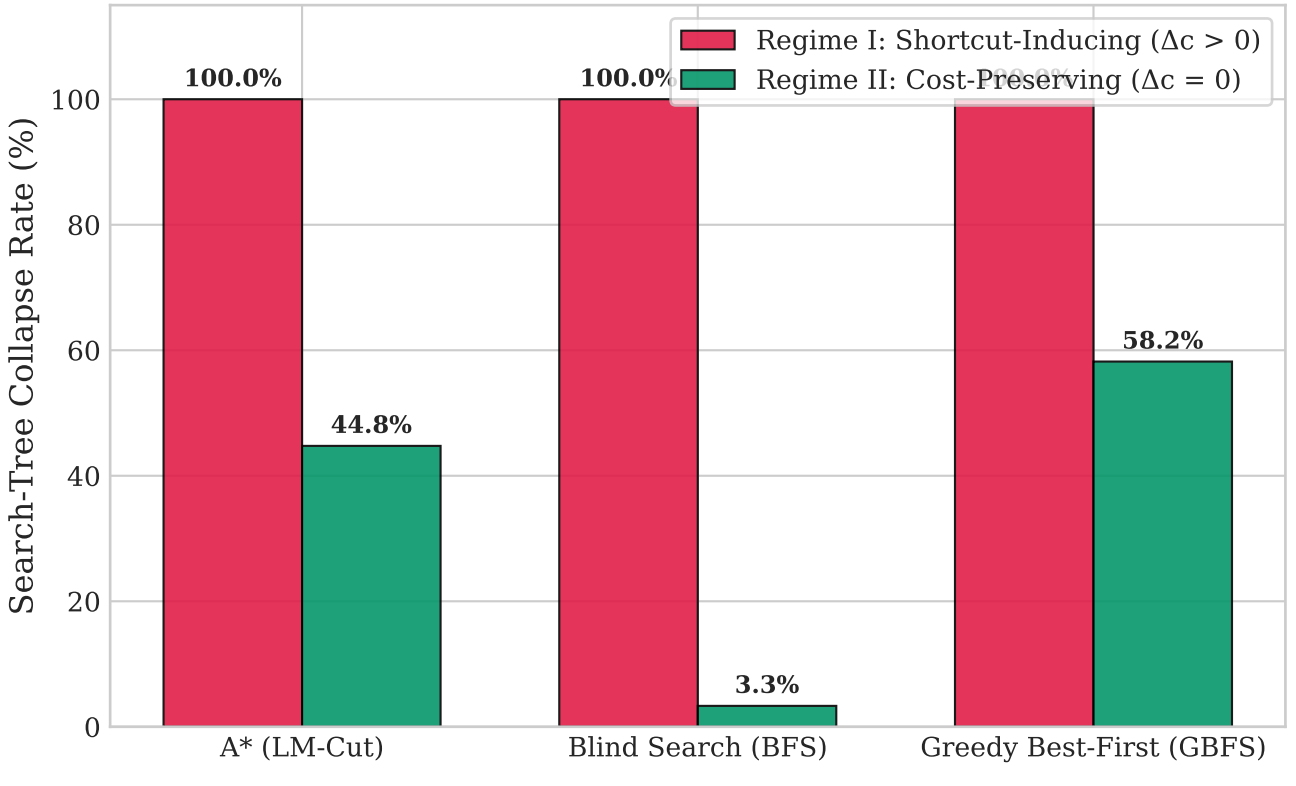
Figure 1: Empirical Collapse Rate Across 1,080 Runs ($p < 10^{-15}$)
Regime I: Shortcut-Inducing (Δc > 0)
Regime II: Cost-Preserving (Δc = 0)
Search-Tree Collapse Rate (%)
0
20
40
60
80
100
100.0%
44.8%
100.0%
3.3%
58.2%
A* (LM-Cut)
Blind Search (BFS)
Greedy Best-First (GBFS)